

CLAUDE CODE × SERVICENOW SDK

Video 2: Authentication

Connect to Your ServiceNow Instance — OAuth & Basic

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Prerequisites

- Video 1 setup completed (Node.js, SDK, Claude Code, sndev skill)
- A ServiceNow instance (PDI or sandbox) with admin or app_developer access
- Instance URL (e.g., <https://dev12345.service-now.com>)

Option A — Basic Authentication (Quick Setup)

Basic auth uses a username and password. Best for Personal Developer Instances and quick development.

Step 1: Save credentials

```
now-sdk auth --add <your-instance>
```

Replace `<your-instance>` with your actual instance name. The SDK will prompt you for your password.

Step 2: Understand the flags

Flag	Purpose
mydev	A friendly alias for this connection — you'll use this in other commands

Step 3: Verify it works

```
now-sdk auth --list
```

If this runs without errors and starts downloading type definitions, your connection is working.

WARNING: Your password is stored in the OS keychain (macOS Keychain, Windows Credential Manager, Linux Secret Service) — NOT in any project file. Never create `.env` files with passwords.

Option B — OAuth 2.0 Authentication (Production)

OAuth uses token-based auth with automatic refresh. Required for SSO-enabled instances and recommended for production work.

Step 1: Install the ServiceNow IDE on your instance

1. Log into your ServiceNow instance as admin
2. Open Application Manager (System Applications → All Available Applications → All)
3. Search for “ServiceNow IDE”
4. This pre-configures the OAuth endpoint the SDK needs

Step 2: Authenticate from the CLI

```
now-sdk auth --add <your-instance>
```

1. The SDK prompts type of auth. Choose OAuth
2. Your browser opens the ServiceNow login page
3. Sign in with your credentials (or SSO provider)
4. After login, ServiceNow displays a one-time token in the browser
5. Copy the token, paste it back into the terminal, press Enter

Step 3: Set as default (optional)

```
now-sdk auth --add mydev-oauth --type oauth --default
```

OAuth tokens refresh automatically. You won't need to re-authenticate unless the refresh token expires.

Step 4: Verify

```
now-sdk auth -list
```

Which Should You Use?

	Basic Auth	OAuth 2.0
Setup time	30 seconds	2–3 minutes
SSO support	No	Yes
Token refresh	N/A (sends creds each call)	Automatic
Best for	PDIs, quick prototyping	Production, SSO, team environments
Instance config	None needed	None

For this course, either method works. Use whichever matches your instance setup.

TIP: You can have multiple auth profiles saved. Switch between them using the `--auth` flag on any SDK command.